

Finals Essay Task 1.

Assessment on your Understanding as to what really matters to become Data Analysts.

And How to integrate SQL into your Data Analysis

Instruction:

Read the attached Article and video link before answering the questions.

Video link: <https://youtu.be/hGCKdMsfU7g>

Article Link:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1FhanZgD5YFiBJP0088UbEWaN7DEFbgiE/view?usp=sharing>

Following the video that you have watch and article that I ask you to read please answer the ff: question using your own words in 2–3 sentences based on the provided source material.

1. What are the four primary factors that will differentiate a data analyst candidate in 2026?

The four primary factors are having domain knowledge, understanding the technical ecosystem, having soft skills that actually matter, and having a strong reason why. Having these four factors are gonna be your edge if you want to be a data analyst this 2026

2. How does domain knowledge provide a competitive advantage over purely technical candidates?

Having experience will make you more valuable since a technical candidate may make accurate outputs but without experience they may miss on what they actually need to show. Not like you having domain knowledge already you can ask better question and interpret data correctly.

3. What is the "lean tech stack" recommended for a foundational data analyst role?

The tools recommended are excel, sql,tableau/power BI these are the recommended foundation tools to learn. even tho you don't learn everything just having enough knowledge in these can help you gain foundation and you can search google for help in the future.

4. Distinguish between "learning projects" and "showing projects."

The learning projects are where you use clean data sets or practicing one tool at a time or focusing on learning on some more fundamentals. while showing projects are the projects you can show where you use messy data and use all the tools that you have learn and work them all together.

5. According to the roadmap, why is Python often deprioritized for mid-career data analyst positions?

because even though python is often put in the job description you don't often get tested on this language. since your stakeholders often don't know how to read python languages and will need visual presentation.

Questions on SQL-Base on the Article Posted

6. Why is establishing the "Business Context" essential for an analyst? What is a Business Context?

Business context means understanding what the data represents, what problem to solve, and who will use the results. It is essential because it helps the analyst ask the right questions and produce relevant insights.

7. According to the text, how does SQL function as a "flashlight"?

sql is described as a flashlight because you need to go step by step first rather than take everything at once. by being curious you can see the small error hidden in rows and columns instead of looking at it at full view where these tiny errors will be hidden.

8. Why is the validation step considered a professional necessity rather than an optional task?

It is necessary because it helps identify errors like impossible values, incorrect dates, or invalid ranges before analysis. without validating it may lead to wrong insights and embarrassing mistakes. It builds credibility and ensures reliable results.

9. What defines "good SQL" according to the author's standards?

According to the author's standards it is easy to read, easy to explain, and easy to trust. Since the goal is to make queries understandable and reliable.

10. Describe the fundamental mindset shift required to move from being a student to being an analyst.

The shift is from thinking I wrote a query to this query answers a business question. A student will focus on execution and an analyst focuses on purpose and impact and this thinking is what separates an analyst from a student.

